

No Strings Attached

This little guide is indispensable, even though we're saying it ourselves! We simply must, because what we've put together here is a collection of freeware in all the categories of computer usage that matter, from an office suite to prank software you can use on a friend. It's all there.

Some amongst us have gone bad and prefer to pirate stuff, which we don't like. We like our software either paid or free—and interestingly, there's free stuff for almost everything you'd need to accomplish.

Covered here are system tools, which affect every aspect of your computer; multimedia tools to play and manipulate your media files; software you'd use when connected to the Internet; applications for your mobile phone; tools to increase your productivity, whether at work or at home; desktop enhancements and such; and developer tools. We've also thrown in a few free games, and a guide to where you can find entertainment online.

Like we hinted at, the best thing about this guide is that you'll want to install almost everything—unless you're a pirate. Except for the chapter on “fun” software, every software we've covered here will be useful to most people.

It's not true in the software world that the best things come free, and we naturally have to admit that some freeware don't perform as well as their paid counterparts do. But that's to be expected, and the beauty of it, in fact, lies in the reverse assertion: some freeware are as good as their paid equivalents! Also, we should add that majority of what we present here is not “nagware,” software that prompts you to buy the full version. We've made a conscious effort to keep much of the nagware out, so you won't feel any guilt pangs.

We've made it simple for you—almost everything we speak about here, we've provided on our CD/DVD for this month, and some more—so you won't need to download a thing. As you use these software, don't forget to thank all those developers out there—if you can't trace them and send them a postcard, a silent prayer of thanks will do!